runs, and Henry had to bowl so poorly that he would be hit for more than 50 runs in his allotted 10 overs.

Fortunately, I came to my senses …

Before the game started, I began to have second thoughts about the whole affair. It just seemed too risky, even though I didn't really believe that chucking my wicket for less than 20 would have much impact on the game. But I realised that if I was caught, I'd be out of the game for a very long time. Possibly for life … It was just not worth it. I told Hansie how I felt, and he said, 'Don't worry about it, Hersch. Let's just forget about the whole thing.'

With Hansie, you could never tell whether or not he was being serious about something. He was really tough to read. And he was playing this story as if it were a bit of a joke, like it wasn't that big a deal. Like … if we went for it, it was cool; if we didn't go for it, it was also cool.

I ended up scoring 74 off 53 balls in the match, playing a cracker of an innings, with 13 fours and a six. And it wasn't like I was just slogging, either. I played a range of proper cricket shots – drives over cover, controlled pulls and hooks – I basically had a fat jol out there. I remember Indian cricketer Ajay Jadeja (himself later bust for match fixing and banned for five years, though this would be overturned) chirping from slip, 'Hersch, you got a train to catch or what's the story?'

Hansie played a blazing innings as well, really teeing off. He smashed a quick-fire 38 off 28 balls and only got out to an amazing catch by Rahul Dravid at slip. Henry Williams, who had obviously also decided to bin the whole match-throwing idea, injured himself after one over and didn't bowl again in that game, so he was also in the clear.

We ended up scoring 320 and then bowling India out for 310 in an entertaining game. And that, I thought, was that. I reckoned I'd had a small brush with a nasty part of cricket, but that it was probably small potatoes. Thankfully I'd passed on the offer, and I subsequently never gave it another thought.

That is, until 7 April 2000, when news broke that Delhi's Chief of Police, KK Paul, was charging Hansie, Nicky Bojé, Henry Williams, Pieter Strydom and Herschelle Gibbs with match fixing. Indian police were allegedly in possession of 14 taped phone conversations between Hansie and Delhi-based Indian bookie Sanjeev Chawla, discussing match fixing. And my name apparently came up several times in these conversations.